2 Timothy 4

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Full teaching files

2 Timothy 1 1-5	*3 pages*
2 Timothy 1 7-12	*2 pages*
2 Timothy 1 13	*2 pages*
2 Timothy 2 2 Teacher's Copy	*3 pages*
2 Timothy 4 1-4 student	*1 pages*
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Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.



2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. This week we will be introduced to one of the greatest example of discipleship at its truest form in the Bible. This letter written to Timothy from his disciple Paul, is the perfect example of how practical _____brings better service, more love, and more glory to God. In our relationships between one another as Christians we should always be seeking to push each other closer to God. Throughout this series we will see how among ourselves we can live differently to help encourage one another to serve God better and glorify him more.

II. 2 Timothy overview

A. **Historical**- This letter was written near the year _____ . The letter was written by Paul to his beloved disciple Timothy, shortly before his martyrdom (2 Timothy 4:6-8) This is Paul's final letter he wrote, that we have recorded in the Holy Bible.

B. **Doctrinal**- This letter is a picture of the deeper meaning to discipleship. The book as a whole is a very great example of the relationship between a disciple and discipler and how discipleship helps us to endure in our Christian lives to the end. Also, chapter 3 of this epistle is a prophecy of the end times, and can be used to determine just how close we are to the end now.

C. **Devotional**- We can learn so much about how we ought to treat each other practically as brothers and sisters in Christ. The overall goal of discipleship is to _____ closer with God in the end, and this book will show us key ways to do this!

III. 1 Timothy 1: 1-5

A. Vs. 2 "Dearly beloved son"

1. Think of one another as family

a) **Romans 12:10**- “Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love; in honour preferring one another;”
b) **1 Thessalonians 3:12**- “But as touching brotherly love ye need not that I write unto you: for ye yourselves are taught of God to love one another.”
c) **Revelation 3:7-13**- **“**_____**”**- From the name of a city in Asia Minor mentioned in Revelation in the New Testament. The name of the city meant "brotherly love" from Greek φιλεω (phileo) "to love" and αδελφος (adelphos) "brother". It is also the name of a city in the United States.

B. Vs 3 “without ceasing I have remembrance of thee in my prayers night and day”
   1. We need to be praying for each other
      a) **1 Thessalonians 5:17**- “Pray without ceasing.”
      b) **Matthew 9:38**- “Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he will send forth labourers into his harvest.”
      c) **Matthew 26:41**- “Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.”
      d) **Mark 11:24**- “Therefore I say unto you, What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.”
         (1) Ultimately we need to be _____ for God’s will to be done! Pray for him to be glorified, and always keep in mind that if you don’t believe he will answer then he won’t!

C. Vs. 4 “Greatly desiring to see thee, being mindful of thy tears, that I may be filled with joy:”
   1. We need this kind of affection; to bear the burdens of our family!
      a) **John 15:13**- “Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends.”
      b) **Romans 15:1-3**- “We then that are strong ought to bear the infirmities of the weak, and not to please ourselves. Let every one of us please his neighbour for his good to

edification. For even Christ pleased not himself; but, as it is written, The reproaches of them that reproached thee fell on me."

(1) This is discipleship; iron sharpening iron! If we want to succeed as Christians we need one another to strengthen each other

(a) Romans 15:30- "Now I beseech you, brethren, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, and for the love of the Spirit, that ye strive together with me in your prayers to God for me;"

IV. In these first 5 verses of the epistle of love from the discipler Paul, to his disciple Timothy, we have so much we can learn. Discipleship in the Bible is a pattern of _____ discipleship, but the practical everyday iron sharpening iron relationship between Christians is there as well! In order to reach our lost friends at school and in our lives, we need to sharpen and pray for one another! Alone, we may lead even 15-20 lost friends to salvation in high school, **but** _____ one another, we can reach 10x that through discipleship. Next week, let's try again to double in size by each one of us bringing just 1 friend to Bible study! This is the work of the Lord.



2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. This week we will be discussing the Biblical mandate to go and do the work of the Lord, despite what the world throws our way. In these few verses found in chapter one of 2 Timothy, we will find that we are all called to be _____of the gospel of Christ. When these afflictions arise, we must be able to continue on and endure to the end, or else we may fail in our mission. Paul is writing to his disciple Timothy to encourage him to press forward despite _____. Discipleship is the only means by which we will be able to endure to the end of our mission. Without each other, we would grow weary fast and never be able to glorify God with our lives.

II. 2 Timothy 1:7-8, 12

A. Vs. 7- fear is NEVER from God

1. **Proverbs 3:5-7**- “Trust in the Lord with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy way acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.”
2. **Isaiah 55:8**- “For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, saith the LORD.”
    a) So often we like to try to make our own plans in our lives. If we believe in God and who the Bible says he is, then we should always be consulting God in our decisions! Then he will direct your paths. We can see the here and now. God can see the beginning from the end. The more time we spend with him, the more prepared he will make us for what he sees lying ahead in our lives.

B. Vs. 7- his spirit gives us power, love, and a sound mind

1. Our God is a God of peace. He wants nothing more than for our lives to be _____ and glorifying to him at the same time!
    a) **Matthew 11: 28-30**- “Come unto me, all *ye* that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls. For my yoke *is* easy, and my burden is light.”

C. Vs. 8- _____ is apart of the true Christian life!

1. **2 Timothy 3:12**- “Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.”

2. **John 15:18**- “If the world hate you, ye know that it hated me before it hated you.”
3. **John3:19-20**- “ And this is the condemnation, that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil. For every one that doeth evil hateth the light, neither cometh to the light, lest his deeds should be reproved.”
    a) This is why people hate and persecute those that do good! They hate the light. They don’t want to have to change.
4. **2 Corinthians 4:6-18**- READ
    a) Paul calls this a _____ How much lighter is our affliction in our lives!

D. Vs. 12- Trusting in God to bring us through to the end

1. **Hebrews 12:1-2**
    a) **Our example of enduring persecutions**: Jesus Christ
    b) **How he endured:** The joy that was set before him
    c) **How we must endure**: The _____. Eternal life with God! We know he promises eternal salvation. Now that we are saved, the worst that can happen is we are killed for our faith and we go to heaven! That is the joy set before us.
2. Discipleship
    a) In Paul’s final letter to Timothy, he says the word “endure” 4x!
        (1) 2 Tim. 2:3,10; 4:3,5
            (a) Discipleship….. This is the iron sharpening iron relationship we need! Paul knew his disciple Timothy would face great persecution. So he writes a final letter to his disciple to say “endure” In ALL of Paul’s epistles he says “endure” 7x. 4 are in this letter!

III. God has a huge mission for us this year! We are called to reach this school with the glorious gospel of Jesus Christ! It will be tough, embarrassing, and scary at times; but that is NOT from God. Satan’s plan is to scare us to the point where we don’t share the gospel. If he wins at making us fear, then he will win in his pursuit of stopping the _____ God has given us! In order to reach our friends, we cannot let him win. For the joy God has set before us, let’s endure to the end this week. Be bold to invite friends and share the good news this week.



2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. Today we continue to take a look at the final letter of Paul to his disciple Timothy. Paul is writing to Timothy to encourage him to press forward and to continue on in the faith for Jesus Christ. Today we examine Paul telling Timothy to hold fast to the form of sound words, which he heard of Paul (also would be known to us as the Bible or the Word of God). In order to be faithful disciples of Jesus Christ we need to be spending time with him, and that can only be done through reading his words and praying to him.

II. 2 Tim. 1:13-14

A. "Hold fast"- This term as it is used in the Bible is used to describe much zeal for something. You grab ahold of it quickly because it is so dear to you.

1. **Job 27:6**- "My righteousness I hold fast, and will not let it go: my heart shall not reproach me so long as I live."
2. **Proverbs 4:13**- "Take fast hold of instruction; let her not go: keep her; for she is thy life."
3. **Psalm 119: 97,113,163,165**
    a) This is the kind of desire we must have for the Word of God! If we love something we will not let it go. We will keep in it our close reach.

B. Our love for God IS shown by our love for his Word

1. God is perfect; therefore he cannot say anything he would take back. His words are a TRUE reflection of who he is!
    a) **Psalm 138:2**- "I will worship toward thy holy temple, and praise thy name for thy lovingkindness and for thy truth: for thou hast magnified thy word about all thy name."
    b) **John 1:1**- "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God."
        (1) God and his words are ONE. They are inseparable.

C. "form of sound words"

1. We must make sure that the words we are hearing are sound words
    a) **1 Cor. 14:33,40**- "For God is not the author of confusion, but of peace, as in all churches of the saints. Let all things be done decently and in order."
        (1) God is a God of order and reason. He will never not make sense, contradict, cause chaos, or confusion.

b) **2 Tim. 4:3**- “For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine; but after their own lusts shall they heap to themselves teachers, having itching ears;”

(1) Men’s words cannot be more important than God’s Word.This is why we must learn to study the Bible for ourselves so that we can have a personal relationship with God.

D. “which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus. That good thing which was committed unto thee keep by the Holy Ghost which dwelleth in us.”

1. Paul is expounding on the Word of God to his disciple (**Acts 8:26-31; Vs. 14**)
    a) We cannot depend on another person to tell us what the scriptures say. But one way or another we will have to learn how to read and apply the scriptures.
        (1) **1 Cor. 12:8**- “For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit;”
2. Pray to God to help us understand the Bible or to send someone our way to help us understand
    a) Acts 8:26-31
        (1) God has a divine appointment where he sends Philip to this man who wants to know more about the Word of God and what it means! God is faithful to help out those who are truly seeking to know him more

E. What we must now do

1. Be saved (without the Holy Spirit we cannot understand the Bible well)
2. Commit to be in the Word of God and actively pray for God to help you understand it/ if you don’t still, actively pray for God to send someone your way to help you understand (Acts 8)
3. Take the Bible for what it says. STUDY it (it will be WORK, you will have to take many things into consideration when studying the Bible: find context, rightly divide the Word, who God is speaking to, etc.)
    a) **2 Timothy 2:15**- “Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.”
    b) **1 Corinthians 2:15**- “Which things also we speak, not in the words which man’s wisdom teacheth, but which the Holy Ghost teacheth; comparing spiritual things with spiritual.”
    c) **Colossians 3:16**- “Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom; teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your hearts to the Lord.”



2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. Today we will discuss the topic of discipleship in the Bible. Discipleship is the believers ministry; without it we can have no fruit that remains, we cannot glorify God, and we cannot fulfill our mission as believers. In this key verse for discipleship in the bible, Paul is writing to his DISCIPLE Timothy to tell him to pass on the things he has taught him to other faithful men who will teach others as well. This is a key part of our lives as Christians and a clear cut example and command given by Jesus after he left this world. In order to be true Christians "little Christs" following in our saviors footsteps, we must fulfill this biblical mandate.

II. 2 Timothy 2:2

A. "And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses"

1. First, Timothy must know that these are true words Paul is speaking

a) **2 Timothy 1:13-** "Hold fast that form of sound words, which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus."

b) **2 Peter 3:15-** "And account that the longsuffering of our Lord is salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also according to the wisdom given unto him hath written unto you; As also in all his epistles, speaking in them of these things; in which are some things hard to be understood, which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures, unto their own destruction."

(1) No matter who is telling us what to believe we need to ALWAYS search the scriptures to find out the truth of the matter. The Word of God is the final authority for true Christians: not the words of imperfect men.

(2) Timothy knew he could hearken to the words of Paul because Paul was known to write under the inspiration of

God. Obviously we have his words recorded in the Holy Bible today and even Peter said Paul was inspired.

2. 2 Corinthians 11:2-4, 13-15

a) Here we see false gospels, <u>false Jesus</u> (there is such a thing; there is only one true Jesus), and false spirits. In general there are false doctrines which are being preached all over!

b) Who is preaching them? (vs. 13-15)

(1) False apostles, deceitful workers, who TRANSFORM THEMSELVES INTO ANGELS OF LIGHT.

(2) "¨<u>his</u> ministers". Satan has ministers, who show themselves to be angels of light, or ministers of righteousness

(3) We can weed these false ministers out by simply reading, studying, and believing the Word of God. They cannot teach from the Word or else they would be found out to be false ministers

B. "the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also."

1. "faithful men"

a) John 17:4-8

(1) Here Jesus is praying to his Father and states that he has finished the work that he gave him to do. But Jesus had not died yet? So what was this work? Discipleship (vs. 5-8)

(2) Jesus did not pick the holiest men. He did not pick the men who claimed to know the OT the best (Pharisees). He didn't pick the men that tithed the most, loved the most, knew the most, or even believed the most. He picked the faithful men who would continue on after he died and left! If the 12 were not faithful after Jesus death we would not be here today! (Acts 1:1-11)

b) Discipleship is about faithful men who will endure to the end, teach others what God has shown them, and multiply believers! We need to invest in faithful men who will not fall away and quit!

III. After looking at this simple verse in Paul's second letter to his beloved disciple Timothy, we can learn about our whole ministry as believers! With discipleship alone, we can

learn to discern from true and false teachers, learn to find faithful men, and multiply believers to reach the whole lost world! Without encouraging and discipling other believers we would become a few saved people who never learned to share the gospel, read the Bible, or have a personal walk with God; and we would die off fast. It is because of discipleship that we are here today, because of faithful men who taught others also!



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

I. The _____ - 2 Tim. 4:1

   a. Always live with two judgments in the front of your mind

      i. Judgment of the "quick" (Judgment Seat of Christ)- Romans 14:10-12; 2 Cor. 5:9-10; Luke 19:11-27; 1 Cor. 3:11-15

      ii. Judgment of the "_____" (Great White Throne Judgment)- Dan. 12:2; John 5:28-29; Ecc. 12:14; Rev. 20:11-15

II. The _____ - 2 Tim. 4:2-4

   a. Preach the word (the gospel, coming judgement, righteousness and truth in all situations)- Mark 16:15; 1 Cor. 15:1; Col. 1:28

      i. In Season, Out of Season- Acts 5:40-42; Acts 16:23-25, 30-32

      ii. Reprove, Rebuke, Exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine- 2 Tim. 3:16-17; Jer. 1:9-10; 2 Tim. 2:24-25

      iii. Especially against the poor doctrine and lust fulfilling preaching/teachers who lead people away from the truth and only tell stories- Amos 8:11-12; 1 Tim. 4:1-3; 2 Pet. 2:1-3

III. We have a responsibility to preach the word of God (the gospel and biblical truths- 1 Tim. 3:15- *But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.)* We live in perilous times of false teachings, worldliness, and a famine of the word of God. With coming _____ and eternity in mind, we can preach as we are called to and actually make a difference.



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

I. A quick background on this chapter: Paul is in prison, in Rome, writing his last book/letter ever to his beloved disciple Timothy. He is about to be executed and these are his final words of charge to his disciple (and to all those who have read them the last 2,000 years).

II. The **Motivation**- 2 Tim. 4:1

- a. Always live with two judgments in the front of your mind
  - i. Judgment of the "quick" (Judgment Seat of Christ)- Romans 14:10-12; 2 Cor. 5:9-10; Luke 19:11-27; 1 Cor. 3:11-15
    1. This is the **judgment** seat, it is a day of "judgment" and of "suffering loss" BUT it can and should be a day of "reward" and of hearing "well done thou good and faithful servant"
    2. Gold- Deity/Holiness- How holy are you living your life? Are you being conformed to the image of Christ everyday? Or are you being conformed to this world?- Exo.25:11; 1 Kings 6:22; Rev. 21:18
    3. Silver- Redemption/Purchasing- Are you leading people to the Lord? God gives the increase when we share the gospel, sometimes we don't see it because we aren't sowing consistently enough.- Num. 3:47-48; 18:15-16; Zach. 11:12-13; Matt. 26:15
    4. Precious Stones- Connected to people/sons- Discipleship and building people up. Are you investing in others? Are you seeing someone grow in Christ under your guidance as a "child"?- Mal. 3:17; 1 Pet. 2:5
    5. What you are doing on a day to day basis has eternal implications: every idle moment, worthless effort, investment in the fleshly and temporal world, will amount to nothing but wood, hay, and stubble and it will burn up at this judgment. You will watch your life and all of your time, effort, and all you built apart from God, BURN UP into nothing; wasted
  - ii. Judgment of the "**dead**" (Great White Throne Judgment)- Dan. 12:2; John 5:28-29; Ecc. 12:14; Rev. 20:11-15
    1. This is a day of wrath, final judgment, wailing, horror, and the result is eternal burning, suffering, and torment
    2. Those who are dead and in "Hell" now will be raised from the dead bodily, to then be judged by God for their sin, and then Death and Hell are thrown into the Lake of Fire, and then these are judged and thrown in. NEVER TO LEAVE AGAIN.
    3. We need to keep this judgement in mind at all times. No, we won't be judged at this, our sins are forgiven and were judged at the cross, but WHAT ABOUT THOSE we know that will be here? WE WILL BE IN ATTENDANCE HERE. Who do you still need to reach?

III. The **Mandate**- 2 Tim. 4:2-4

a. Preach the word (the gospel, coming judgement, righteousness and truth in all situations)- Mark 16:15; 1 Cor. 15:1; Col. 1:28
    i. In Season, Out of Season- Acts 5:40-42; Acts 16:23-25, 30-32
    ii. Reprove, Rebuke, Exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine- 2 Tim. 3:16-17; Jer. 1:9-10; 2 Tim. 2:24-25
    iii. Especially against the poor doctrine and lust fulfilling preaching/teachers who lead people away from the truth and only tell stories- Amos 8:11-12; 1 Tim. 4:1-3; 2 Pet. 2:1-3
        1. Amos 8:11-12- **hearing of the words of the Lord**; *the word of God does not exist anymore in the opinion of the majority today*
        2. 1 Tim. 4:1-3- **seducing spirits**; *charismatic movement, fake miracles, lies, experience over everything, not biblical.* **Doctrines of devils**; *what are devilish doctrines?* (Rev. 2:9; 3:9) *replacement theology. (1 Jn. 2:22; 4:3; 2 Jn. 1:7) denying the deity of Christ (JW'S, Mormons, Muslims, etc..)*
        3. 2 Pet. 2:1-3- **damnable heresies;** *denying the Lord that bought them, adding to salvation or misrepresenting salvation (Calvinists, most protestant groups, anyone who adds baptism to salvation);* **make merchandise of you;** *prosperity gospel preaching, many non denominational groups, music, worship, experience, a good time (they are buying you with seeker friendly services) because they are more interested in numbers, money, tithing, than preaching the truth*
            a. Interestingly, one group is a catch all for all of these: the Catholic Church (**no final authority**, they are the authority; **seducing spirits**; charismatic teachings, miracles, experiences, fake healings, etc..; **doctrines of devils and damnable heresies**, the original replacement theologians, against the jews, denying Jesus as God by making men into mediators, worshipping Mary, adding to salvation with the "sacraments"; **making merchandise of you**, indulgences (paying money for less time in purgatory for you/your family), relics of healing/blessing (Churches displayed relics (bones of saints, pieces of the cross, etc.), charging money to view them or promising spiritual benefit); Masses for the Dead (Families could pay priests to say Masses for souls in purgatory, believed to reduce their suffering)

IV. We have a responsibility to preach the word of God (mostly the gospel; also Biblical truths- 1 Tim. 3:15-*But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.)* We live in perilous times of false teachings, worldliness, and a famine of the word of God. With coming **judgment** and eternity in mind, we can preach as we are called to and actually make a difference.
    a. Are you prepared to preach? Do you know the gospel/bible truths?
    b. Are you prepared to do it "out of season"
    c. Are you living with the coming judgement and eternity in mind daily?



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:5

1) _____ thou in all things
   a) Watch out for yourself- Mark 14:38; 1 Cor. 16:13
   b) Watch out for those around you- Eze. 33:1-7
   c) Watch as the time of the end gets closer- 1 Pet. 4:7; Mark 13:33-37; Matt. 24:42
      i) Quit living like nothing is happening, like there are no changes coming, like he isn't coming back- Matt. 24:37-39
2) Endure _____
   a) Don't just "get through" them, expect them and "endure through" them- 2 Tim. 1:8; 2:3,10; 3:10-12
   b) 1 Pet. 5:8-11- You endure afflictions:
      i) With other believers (vs. 9)
      ii) To be perfected (vs. 10)
      iii) To bring God glory (vs. 11)
   c) Two ways to live and their two outcomes
      i) Heb. 11:25-26- Temporary pleasure- Eternal Loss
      ii) 2 Cor. 4:17-18- Temporary affliction- Eternal Gain
         (1) What are you enduring?
3) Do the _____ of an evangelist
   a) Why does Paul remind Timothy of this? <u>Evangelism is lacking in the last days</u>
   b) Evangelist/evangelism shows up 3x in the Bible
      i) Eph. 4:11- One of the spiritual gifts
      ii) 2 Tim. 4:5- Paul reminding the young pastor Timothy to do this work of evangelism
      iii) Acts 21:8- Philip the evangelist
         (1) We see Philip in Acts a few times preaching Jesus Christ- Acts 8:4-5,12,35
   c) What is evangelism?
      i) Preaching Jesus Christ! His life, death, and resurrection; preaching the gospel
      ii) It is work
   d) The Biblical command to share the gospel/be evangelists is clear

i) Matt. 4:23; 9:35; 10:7; 11:5; 24:14; 26:13; Mark 1:14–15; 1:38–39; 3:14; 6:12; 13:10; 14:9; 16:15–16; 16:20; Luke 4:18–19; 4:43–44; 7:22; 8:1; 9:2; 9:6; 16:16; 24:47; Acts 5:42; 8:4; 8:5; 8:12; 8:25; 8:35; 8:40; 9:20; 10:36; 10:42; 11:20; 13:5; 13:32; 13:38; 13:49; 14:7; 14:15; 14:21; 15:7; 15:35; 16:10; 17:18; 20:25; 28:31; Rom. 1:15; 10:14–15; 15:19–20; 1 Cor. 1:17; 1:21; 1:23; 9:14; 9:16; 9:18; 15:1; 15:11; 15:14; 2 Cor. 4:5; 10:16; 11:7; Gal. 1:8–9; 1:11; 1:16; 1:23; 2:2; 2:7; 3:8; 4:13; Eph. 2:17; 3:8; 4:11; 6:19; Phil. 1:14–18; Col. 1:23; 1:28; 1 Thess. 2:2; 2:4; 2:9; 1 Tim. 2:7; 3:16; 2 Tim. 1:11; 4:2; 4:5; Titus 1:3; Heb. 4:2; 4:6; 1 Pet. 1:12; 1:25; 4:6

4) Make _____ proof of thy ministry

a) Finish the job, don't do half of the job, don't quit early- Col 4:17; John 17:4; Gal 6:9



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:5

1) **Watch** thou in all things
   a) Watch out for yourself- Mark 14:38; 1 Cor. 16:13
   b) Watch out for those around you- Eze. 33:1-7
   c) Watch as the time of the end gets closer- 1 Pet. 4:7; Mark 13:33-37; Matt. 24:42
      i) Wake up!
      ii) Quit living like nothing is happening, like there are no changes coming, like he isn't coming back- Matt. 24:37-39
      iii) Live like it is your last day, your last chance to reach those around you! WATCH!
      iv) The signs are there! Don't make the same mistake as so many others have, heed the warning of Jesus himself and watch!
2) Endure **afflictions**
   a) Don't just "get through" them, expect them and "endure through" them- 2 Tim. 1:8; 2:3,10; 3:10-12
   b) 1 Pet. 5:8-11- You endure afflictions:
      i) With other believers (vs. 9)
      ii) To be perfected (vs. 10)
      iii) To bring God glory (vs. 11)
   c) Two ways to live and their two outcomes
      i) Heb. 11:25-26- Temporary pleasure- Eternal Loss
         (1) Moses chose not to live for the temporary pleasure of this "world" (Egypt) and will have eternal reward
         (2) Theses verses show us that to choose temporary pleasure in this life means to choose eternal loss of reward
      ii) 2 Cor. 4:17-18- Temporary affliction- Eternal Gain
         (1) Paul said that while our affliction is "but for a moment" but it brings a FAR MORE eternal weight of glory, eternal reward and gain
      iii) What are you enduring?
         (1) Loss of friends? Ridicule at school? Any sort of backlash for your beliefs/sharing Christ with people? For your testimony?
         (2) What have you "suffered" because you gave it up?
            (a) Moses gave up the riches of Egypt (all the world had to offer) for wandering in the wilderness (but later eternal reward)
            (b) Have you given up anything that has "afflicted" you? Something you gave up to follow Jesus Christ that caused you suffering, loss, affliction?
               (i) social media, sports, relationships, boyfriend, girlfriend, personal aspirations, sex, alcohol, partying, the "high school experience", etc..
3) Do the **work** of an evangelist
   a) Why does Paul remind Timothy of this? Evangelism is lacking in the last days
   b) Evangelist/evangelism shows up 3x in the Bible
      i) Eph. 4:11- One of the spiritual gifts
      ii) 2 Tim. 4:5- Paul reminding the young pastor Timothy to do this work of evangelism

iii) Acts 21:8- Philip the evangelist
(1) We see Philip in Acts a few times preaching Jesus Christ- Acts 8:4-5,12,35

c) What is evangelism?
i) Preaching Jesus Christ! His life, death, and resurrection; preaching the gospel
(1) Paul reminds Timothy over and over to preach the gospel (lookup "preach" almost always, the gospel!), do the work of an evangelist!
ii) It is work
(1) It is not easy, it takes time, effort, being willing to be uncomfortable, willing to GO out, FISH for men, NOT BE ASHAMED, etc.. (Matt. 4:19; Mk. 1:17)
(2) It is an active work, not passive, too many spend their whole lives trying to maneuver, connive, plan, strategize, etc.. and do anything they can to NOT JUST DO THE WORK of an evangelist
(a) Imagine trying to fish by:
(i) waiting for the fish to jump into the boat
(ii) only "casting out a line" to try and catch a fish whenever you happened to see a fish directly in the water
(iii) trying to befriend the fish first; you need to have a relationship with the fish before you can catch them
(iv) trying to catch the fish by making it clear to all of the fish that you are a fishermen and that is your job; hoping that they will see that you are a fisherman and want to be one too
(3) Friendship evangelism, testimony evangelism, not involved in corporate evangelism, NO evangelism, etc..

d) The Biblical command to share the gospel/be evangelists is clear
i) Matt. 4:23; 9:35; 10:7; 11:5; 24:14; 26:13; Mark 1:14–15; 1:38–39; 3:14; 6:12; 13:10; 14:9; 16:15–16; 16:20; Luke 4:18–19; 4:43–44; 7:22; 8:1; 9:2; 9:6; 16:16; 24:47; Acts 5:42; 8:4; 8:5; 8:12; 8:25; 8:35; 8:40; 9:20; 10:36; 10:42; 11:20; 13:5; 13:32; 13:38; 13:49; 14:7; 14:15; 14:21; 15:7; 15:35; 16:10; 17:18; 20:25; 28:31; Rom. 1:15; 10:14–15; 15:19–20; 1 Cor. 1:17; 1:21; 1:23; 9:14; 9:16; 9:18; 15:1; 15:11; 15:14; 2 Cor. 4:5; 10:16; 11:7; Gal. 1:8–9; 1:11; 1:16; 1:23; 2:2; 2:7; 3:8; 4:13; Eph. 2:17; 3:8; 4:11; 6:19; Phil. 1:14–18; Col. 1:23; 1:28; 1 Thess. 2:2; 2:4; 2:9; 1 Tim. 2:7; 3:16; 2 Tim. 1:11; 4:2; 4:5; Titus 1:3; Heb. 4:2; 4:6; 1 Pet. 1:12; 1:25; 4:6
(1) People will make their lives about anything and everything else, all the minor issues, BUT WILL NOT DO THE WORK OF AN EVANGELIST

4) Make **full** proof of thy ministry
a) Finish the job, don't do half of the job, don't quit early- Col 4:17; John 17:4; Gal 6:9
i) Don't do half of a job; don't ONLY watch, or ONLY endure affliction, or ONLY evangelize; DO THE WHOLE JOB
ii) Don't quit early; keep going! Time is short!
iii) Many people do elements of the work of ministry for a time; BUT FEW do all of it and don't quit early (Paul and those he ministered with)
iv) Seniors; don't stop now, do more than you have ever done. See to this ministry God has given you (EDGE) and the one he has given you at school, sports, clubs, etc…
v) Younger students; start growing in this process, keep growing, don't stop growing and serving more each day
vi) If you aren't growing; you are dying



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:6-7

1) _____ the Good Fight
    i) Paul talks over and over again about the Christian life being like a war, here he compares his life to that of a solider- 1 Tim. 6:12; Phil. 2:25; Philemon 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:3-4
    ii) Here, Paul lays out the nature of this "battle" and how to be ready for it- Eph. 6:10-18
  b) Finish your _____
    i) The Christian life is compared to here by Paul to the life of an athlete
      (1) Running with the end/prize in mind- Heb. 12:1-2; Phillip. 3:13-14; 1 Cor. 9:24-27
      (2) The need for training and discipline
        (a) Paul emphasizes that you don't get the prize by "chance" or with laziness but with hard work, temperance, and discipline- 1 Cor. 9:24-27
  c) Keep the _____
    i) Paul ends by saying he "kept the faith"
      (1) We know he is not referring to "keeping" his salvation faith; so what does this mean?
    ii) Our entire Christian lives from salvation on is about "faith- Jude 3; Col. 2:6-7
      (1) Faith shows itself in many ways:
        (a) Obedience to the word of God- Rom. 10:17; Heb. 4:2
        (b) Prayer lives- Jude 20; James 1:5-6
        (c) Our dependance on God- John 15
          (i) Abide in Christ; are you living your life in your power or in his?
      (2) We all need to be able to say with Paul by the end of our lives "I have kept the faith", otherwise we will not have been successful- Heb. 11:6



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:6-7

Paul just told timothy to make full proof of his ministry (keep going, don't stop short, finish the job); and then follows up by telling him HOW he finished his ministry and that his time in life was coming to an end

1) **Fight the Good Fight**
   - i) Paul talks over and over again about the Christian life being like a war, here he compares his life to that of a solider- 1 Tim. 6:12; Phil. 2:25; Philemon 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:3-4
   - ii) Here, Paul lays out the nature of this "battle" and how to be ready for it- Eph. 6:10-18
     - (1) Truth- Are you standing for the truth, do you share it with others when you can
     - (2) Righteousness- Best definition of righteousness; are you doing what is right? Is your life, actions, testimony, speech, etc.. RIGHT?
     - (3) Preparation of the gospel of peace- Are you prepared to share the gospel?
       - (a) So many people are simply NOT PREPARED, and that is why they let opportunities go or don't share the gospel at all
     - (4) Faith- Are you resting in God's power? Belief/trust in God is your main line of defense. God is the true source of power in your Christian life and IT it meant to block the attacks of the "wicked"
     - (5) Helmet of salvation- Assurance of your salvation protects your "head" (your thinking). If you constantly struggle with assurance of your salvation, you don't know that you are saved, then you will not think right and your head is vulnerable to the enemy
     - (6) Sword of the Spirit/Word of God- This is the only offensive/defensive weapon. It is also the only real part of the armor that you must train on to use. The more trained you are with this, the more of a threat you are and the more you can defend yourself.
       - (a) It is the spirit of God who teaches us, the sword/word of God is HIS weapon, we must lean on him to be able to understand/use it
         - (i) ALL OF THE PIECES OF ARMOR ARE NEEDED DAILY to SURVIVE. "to stand". Missing any of them by not making "full proof" of your ministry, can be deadly when you are actively engaged in battle.
         - (ii) If you feel that you don't have these and yet are "unscathed" you are probably not in the battle at all

b) Finish your course

- i) The Christian life is compared to here by Paul to the life of an athlete
  - (1) Running with the end/prize in mind- Heb. 12:1-2; Phillip. 3:13-14; 1 Cor. 9:24-27
    - (a) Jesus Christ endured the cross with the end in mind. We can endure this life with the same mindset
    - (b) Paul talks about running life more like a "marathon" than a spring "with patience/endurance"
    - (c) Paul talked about running to obtain a prize. He ran toward the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus. The prize is the calling, the chance to serve him!

(d) He also talks about running to obtain! Think of the parable of the pounds (I am sure Paul was). He wants to have reward to cast back to Jesus, and that mean running to "obtain". Otherwise you will LOSE out on your reward that you even have.

(2) The need for training and discipline

(a) Paul emphasizes that you don't get the prize by "chance" or with laziness but with hard work, temperance, and discipline- 1 Cor. 9:24-27

(i) The lost world spends HOURS per day, 7 DAYS per week, EVERY WEEK, MONTH, and YEAR to master: sports, academics, acting, music, etc.. YET CHRISTIANS don't work 1% of that to obtain in INCORRUPTIBLE CROWN! Eternal rewards! Souls at stake!

1. If we worked as hard to "obtain" that prize as we do for "corruptible" crowns, this world would be flipped upside down immediately!

(ii) Are you disciplined? In reading, prayer, service, etc.. or are you up and down/inconsistent?

c) <u>Keep the Faith</u>

i) Paul ends by saying he "kept the faith"

(1) We know he is not referring to "keeping" his salvation faith; so what does this mean?

ii) Our entire Christian lives from salvation on is about "faith- Jude 3; Col. 2:6-7

(1) Faith shows itself in many ways:

(a) Obedience to the word of God- Rom. 10:17; Heb. 4:2

(b) Prayer lives- Jude 20; James 1:5-6

(c) Our dependance on God- John 15

(i) Abide in Christ; are you living your life in your power or in his?

1. Do I consistently set aside time to seek Christ through His Word and prayer?
2. When I face decisions, do I turn first to my own reasoning, or do I stop to ask, *"What would the Lord have me do?"*
3. Is my heart more stirred by time with Jesus than by entertainment, work, or achievements?
4. Do I often feel like I can "handle life" on my own, or do I truly recognize, *"Without Him I can do nothing"* (John 15:5)?
5. Am I more quick to worry and stress — or to pray and trust?
6. Do I obey God's Word even when it is inconvenient or costly?
7. How often do I talk with Him throughout my day, not just in "set prayer times"?

(2) We all need to be able to say with Paul by the end of our lives "I have kept the faith", otherwise we will not have been successful- Heb. 11:6

2) Are you in a spiritual battle? If you are, are you prepared for the war?

3) Are you training and disciplined? What reward will you have in heaven to show for it?

4) Are you living in faith? Without faith we cannot please God. What in your life can you point to and be able to say you are "keeping the faith"



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:8

1) There are two kinds of _____ that we lay up for ourselves each day (vs. 8a)
   a) Eternal treasure vs. Earthly treasure (vs. 8; Matt. 6:19-20; 1 Tim. 6:17-19)
      i) There are only two things on this earth that are eternal:
         (1) Souls of men- Mt. 25:46; Jn. 5:28-29
         (2) Word of God- Isa. 40:8; Psa. 119:89; Mt. 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:23-25
2) Crown of _____ (vs. 8b)
   a) Paul says that this crown is specifically for those who look forward to Jesus return- Titus 2:13; Luke 12:35-37
   b) There is more to this than simply being happy about Jesus coming back; we need to "watch" and be aware of the events surrounding us, and he will honor this- Mk. 13:33-37; Mt. 24:42-44; 1 Thess. 5:1-6; Prov. 27:18
   c) What is so important about this crown/the other crowns?
      i) These crowns are separate and specific reward (beside our gold, silver, precious stones from the judgment seat of Christ); these are for specific things we are called to do and can earn crowns for- 1 Thess. 2:19; 2 Tim. 4:8; James 1:1-2; 1 Pet. 5:4
      ii) These crowns are meant to be cast back at Jesus's feet in worship- Rev. 4:4; 10-11

Questions to Consider:

- What are you investing in? Eternal things for an eternal reward? Or temporary things for a temporary/earthly reward?
- Are you living each day WATCHING carefully, living in urgency and anticipation of Jesus return?
- Will you have this crown of righteousness to cast back to Jesus on judgement day?



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:8

1) There are two kinds of **treasure** that we lay up for ourselves each day (vs. 8a)
   i) Looked up this term "laid up; laying up" and God connected the dots
   b) Eternal treasure vs. Earthly treasure (vs. 8; Matt. 6:19-20; 1 Tim. 6:17-19)
   i) Paul knew what kind of treasure he was laying up; his was an eternal reward
   ii) Will have eternal treasure? Or will you suffer loss? (1 Cor. 3:15)
   iii) There are only two things on this earth that are eternal:
   (1) Souls of men- Mt. 25:46; Jn. 5:28-29
   (2) Word of God- Isa. 40:8; Psa. 119:89; Mt. 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:23-25
   (a) A simple test to know if you will have eternal reward? How is your investment into these two things?
   (b) If you are investing time into studying, teaching, preaching the word of God, sharing the gospel, edifying the body of Christ, discipling, etc..) then you are investing in these two eternal investments.
   (c) KEY: ANYTHING AND EVERYTHING ELSE IN YOUR LIFE THAT YOU INVEST IN, even if it may be important, is temporal and laying up treasure on this earth, NOT ETERNAL REWARD
   (d) Anytime you invest in the "necessary evils" of this world (things we all have to do and that our lives require of us) can still build eternal reward WHEN WE USE IT FOR GOD and don't just "drag through"

2) Crown of **righteousness** (vs. 8b)

   This is one of the crowns that we can get based on our service to God in this life

   a) Paul says that this crown is specifically for those who look forward to Jesus return- Titus 2:13; Luke 12:35-37
   i) This goes along with the last point also: if you are earthly minded and fully invested here, you will find this world/life hard to leave and you WONT look forward to his return; BUT if you are heavenly/eternally minded, and investing there, you will not be able to wait to get home!
   b) There is more to this than simply being happy about Jesus coming back; we need to "watch" and be aware of the events surrounding us, and he will honor this- Mk. 13:33-37; Mt. 24:42-44; 1 Thess. 5:1-6; Prov. 27:18
   i) Paul is reminding us to WAKE UP!!

ii) Look around you, look at the world, look at the hatred of God's people Israel, and don't be ignorant of it.

(1) Some Christians talk about this like they don't need/want to look at prophesy or they don't care about it; but we are RESPONSIBLE to know the times and seasons and signs; we will be honored for "waiting for our master" and for "looking forward to his appearing". There is a crown for this! God wouldn't give us the details of the signs and tell us to WATCH, over and over and over and over again, if he didn't care and didn't want us to care

(2) Why is there a crown for this? Because when we watch like this and we are living in anticipation of it, it spurs us to serve more zealously. It give us a sense of urgency! Which we desperately need!

c) What is so important about this crown/the other crowns?

i) These crowns are separate and specific reward (beside our gold, silver, precious stones from the judgment seat of Christ); these are for specific things we are called to do and can earn crowns for- 1 Thess. 2:19; 2 Tim. 4:8; James 1:1-2; 1 Pet. 5:4

ii) These crowns are meant to be cast back at Jesus's feet in worship- Rev. 4:4; 10-11

(1) In this amazing moments of millions of Christians casting crowns back to Jesus to worship him, will you have anything to cast back to him? Or will you stand ashamed and empty handed on that day?

3) What are you investing in? Eternal things for an eternal reward? Or temporary things for a temporary/earthly reward?

4) Are you living each day WATCHING carefully, living in urgency and anticipation of Jesus return?

5) Will you have this crown of righteousness to cast back to Jesus on judgement day?



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Tim. 4:9-22- Finishing Well

1. Demas- This is an example of a believer who starts out _____but does not finish well- Col 4:14; Philemon 24; vs. 10
    a. Loving the world will pull you away from God- 1 John 2:15-16; Luke 8:14
    b. If you love the pleasures of the world more than God? If you do, your life will lack power- 2 Tim. 3:4-5
2. Marcus/Mark- This is an example of a believer who starts out strong, walks away for a _____, but then ends strong- vs. 11
    a. Mark ministered with Paul early on- Col. 4:2; Philemon 24; Acts 12:2, 25
    b. Mark walked away during this time for some reason or another- Acts 13:13; 15:37-39
    c. Mark repented and came back and was profitable- vs. 11; 1 Pet. 5:13
        i. He becomes a disciple of Peter and then writes the gospel of Mark
        ii. No matter where you are today, God's desire is for your repentance, not to wallow in shame/pity- John 8:11; Isa. 55:7; Eze. 18:30-32; Joel 2:12-13; Luke 15:7, 20-24
3. Lucas/Luke & Priscilla and Aquila- These are examples of believers who start out strong, don't become "weary in well doing", and then finish _____- vss. 11, 19
    a. Luke was Paul's personal traveling physician for Paul's thorn in the flesh. He travelled with Paul through the book of Acts all the way to the end of Paul's life- Acts 16:10-11, 12-17; 20:5-6; 21:1,17; 27:1; 28:16; Col. 4:14; Philemon 24
    b. Priscilla and Aquilla were a husband and wife. They were tent makers (like Paul) who faithfully served God wherever he called them- Acts 18:3, 18-19
        i. They had churches meet in their home- 1 Cor. 16:19; Rom. 16:5
        ii. They instructed others who were off in doctrine (discipled)- Acts 18:26
        iii. They laid down their lives for the ministry- Rom. 16: (1 Cor. 15:58)



Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Tim. 4:9-22- Finishing Well

1. Demas- This is an example of a believer who starts out **strong** but does not finish well- Col 4:14; Philemon 24; vs. 10
    a. Loving the world will pull you away from God- 1 John 2:15-16; Luke 8:14
        i. Too many people start off great, but later they fall off, they slowly but surely start to love the world and end up far from God, forsaking him
        ii. Demas traveled with Paul, endured persecution, preached, saw people saved, etc.. but in the end he loved the world more than God
    b. If you love the pleasures of the world more than God? If you do, your life will lack power- 2 Tim. 3:4-5
        i. How do you know if you love somehting? What do you spend your time thinking about? Spend your time with? Spend your energy on? What do you desire/choose the most?
            1. God or: BF/GF, sports, school, video games, tv shows, music, social media, clubs, parties, money, family, social gatherings/places you hangout, etc...
            2. Write it out, what do you spend the most time on? What occupies your time/thinking the most? Be honest: write 1-3 down now.
        ii. Loving this world is a slippery slope, it will lead you away from God
2. Marcus/Mark- This is an example of a believer who starts out strong, walks away for a **season**, but then ends strong- vs. 11
    a. Mark ministered with Paul early on- Col. 4:2; Philemon 24; Acts 12:2, 25
    b. Mark walked away during this time for some reason or another- Acts 13:13; 15:37-39
        i. Maybe he was fearful (they were enduring a lot of persecution during this time), maybe he had business to take care of back home (family member care/funeral), maybe he lacked the faith needed to rely on the provision of God and wanted to go back to his buiness at home.
        ii. Why do we walk away? Sin, cares of the world, fear of persecution/riducule, lack of care for the work/no burdern, too involved in other things, etc.. Whatever it is, we can do what mark did at times
    c. Mark repented and came back and was profitable- vs. 11; 1 Pet. 5:13
        i. He becomes a disciple of Peter and then writes the gospel of Mark
        ii. No matter where you are today, you have fallen away, not kept your commitments (camp), are living a lie/sham, aren't walking with God, have fallen in love iwht the world, have left the work; God's desire is for your repentance,

not to wallow in shame/pity- John 8:11; Isa. 55:7; Eze. 18:30-32; Joel 2:12-13; Luke 15:7, 20-24

1. There are plenty of "pharisean" people out there who want to condemn you; this is Satanic. If you are a believer in here the bible says "There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus". He does not condemn you, he wants your repentance!
2. Think of all the self righteous people who probably heard of this situation with Mark, they probably mocked it and made fun of it; I wonder how many of them got to pen words of the eternally preserved word of God that will last for eternity! God is more interested in your repentance than in your being perfect all the time!

3. Lucas/Luke & Priscilla and Aquila- These are examples of believers who start out strong, don't become "weary in well doing", and then finish **strong**- vss. 11, 19
    a. Luke was Paul's personal traveling physician for Paul's thorn in the flesh. He travelled with Paul through the book of Acts all the way to the end of Paul's life- Acts 16:10-11, 12-17; 20:5-6; 21:1,17; 27:1; 28:16; Col. 4:14; Philemon 24
        i. He was specially trained to be able to write detailed accounts of the gospel and of the early church. Many refer to his writings as being that of a trained "historian" during a time where literacy was very low!
        ii. His training allowed him to help/serve the ministry specially, not being up front but using his skills to serve Paul all the way to the end, and even penning 2 NT books that have eternal impact
    b. Priscilla and Aquilla were a husband and wife. They were tent makers (like Paul) who faithfully served God wherever he called them- Acts 18:3, 18-19
        i. They had churches meet in their home- 1 Cor. 16:19; Rom. 16:5
        ii. They instructed others who were off in doctrine (discipled)- Acts 18:26
        iii. They laid down their lives for the ministry- Rom. 16:4
            1. We can learn a lot from all of these. Even liviing normal lives, normal jobs, etc.. we can use these to serve God WHEN we give them up 100% for him. At risk of our lives, livelihoods, time, home, personal time, WHATEVER THE COST. Our "daily duties" never overtake our commitment to the ministry.
            2. Then we can learn from them in their tenacity. They never gave up, they went all the way to the end. Never fell away. Consistent and reliable.
            3. I hope to hear reports of all of you that you are walking with God, serving faithfully. Whether you faltered for a time (it's better not to), or if you are strong today and stay strong; wherver you find yourself, DRAW CLOSE TO GOD. If you are close today, draw closer. If you fall away, draw closer. Don't be like Demas. Don't let the last word on you be that you loved the world and left the work (1 Cor. 15:58)